



Applying deep pressure to the buttocks and lower back with the thumbs can help you focus and release held-in tension during contractions.

BIRTH STORY: A NATURAL HOME BIRTH

Jenna is a 31-year-old mom and this is her second labor. She had a straightforward birth with her daughter, now three. This pregnancy was uneventful, so she decided to have a home birth this time.

Jenna's story: When I was eight days overdue, my midwife did a “stretch and strip” (see [Stripping the membranes](#)) of my cervix to encourage labor. After that, I had a couple of [bloody shows](#) and irregular contractions. In the night, I woke with contractions 20 minutes apart. I couldn't get back to sleep, so I had a warm bath, took a couple of acetaminophens, and went back to bed. My little